

No. 1 NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF FASHION TECHNOLOGY, NEW DELHI

STYLE ICON

MARRYING MODERN TECHNOLOGY AND CONTEMPORARY TRENDS WITH INDIA'S TRADITIONAL CRAFT, NIFT, NEW DELHI, SHOWS THE WAY FOR THE FUTURE OF FASHION IN INDIA

BY SHELLY ANAND

In a country as multifaceted as India, fashion is as much an expression of the self as it is a reflection of the social milieu we inhabit. It is deeply personal, and yet, a mirror unto itself of a nation's aspirations, its history and identity. Perhaps that's the reason why, say, a humble *dhoti* never goes out of style, or the ever-so-elegant *sari* keeps seeing pretty modern iterations every so often. Set up in 1986, the National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT), New Delhi, is acutely aware of the sheer diversity and scope for experimentation India offers when it comes to fashion, and has consistently tried to expand the boundaries of the industry. It has done so by marrying knowledge with traditional arts, contemporary thought, and innovations in design and technology.

The institute awards degrees in undergraduate, postgraduate and doctoral studies and provides a world-class learning environment. Over the years, it has initiated tie-ups with several international institutes and strengthened its academic framework. Invigorating thought leadership, research stimulus, industry focus, creative enterprise and peer learning have further reinforced the institute's foundation.

NIFT, New Delhi, offers four-year bachelor's programmes in seven domains: accessory design, fashion communication, fashion design, fashion technology, knitwear design, leather design, and textile design. It also offers two-year master's programmes in design, fashion management and fashion technology, as well as short-duration 'Continuing Education' courses. The current batch has about 1,288 students pursuing various programmes at the institute. "Over the years," says Manisha Kinnu, campus director, NIFT, New Delhi, "the role and possibilities of design, management and technology have expanded manifold. At NIFT, New Delhi, we constantly endeavour to stay ahead of the industry and